

PURPOSE: To define the Anonymous Reporting Tool and its procedures in the Student Handbook

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BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE

SECTION ONE (DEFINITIONS):

Anonymous Reporting Tool- website that allows MSMS students to send an anonymous message to MSMS administration about an issue.

SECTION TWO (REASONING):

MSMS administration has stated that they understand that the procedures behind physical or in-person reports can be intimidating for MSMS students. Because of this, they have created the Anonymous Reporting Tool to serve as an alternative method for MSMS students to anonymously enlighten MSMS administration on issues that they might be unaware of. MSMS administration has confirmed that the Anonymous Reporting Tool is not a trial but more a software that is to be implemented in the years to come. Since the Anonymous Reporting Tool allows for more routes for MSMS students to report any issues they come across and will still be utilized in the future, the MSMS Student Handbook should thoroughly define the Anonymous Reporting Tool and the procedures to utilize it.

SECTION TWO (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On Page 16 of the Student Handbook (PDF pages 21), the following will be changed,

Procedures for Reporting, Investigating, and Addressing Bullying or Harassing Behavior

A student who feels he/she has been subject to any act of bullying or harassing behavior and/or a student or volunteer who has witnessed or has reliable information that a student or school employee has been subject to any act of bullying or harassing behavior should report the incident to a school employee, who shall immediately report the incident in writing to the Director for Student Affairs, Director for Academic Affairs, and/or [Executive Director/Superintendent].

Students should report bullying or harassing behavior to a school employee promptly but no later than five (5) working days after the alleged incident(s) occurred.

Non-anonymous reports should include: the name of the reporting person*, the specific nature and date of the misconduct, the name(s) of the victim(s) of the misconduct, the name(s) of any witness(es), the name(s) of the alleged bully, and any other information that would assist in the investigation of the report. *If a student chooses to anonymously report bullying or harassing behavior, the school's ability to take action based solely on an anonymous report may be limited.

Anonymous reports can be made through the Anonymous Reporting Tool. The Anonymous Reporting Tool can be accessed through a link in the School Bulletin Board in PowerSchool. Anonymous reports are to be taken seriously and should thoroughly describe the issue being reported. Although names are not required in anonymous reports, they can be included, but the reports will still be anonymous. If names are provided in the report, only MSMS directors will have this information. In more serious circumstances, only the Executive Director will have this information. MSMS administration states that IP addresses will not be traced when anonymous reports are made. Despite the anonymous nature of the reports, MSMS administration states that their confidentiality limits are the same as other health professions, meaning they have to report suicidality, intent to harm others, and abuse/neglect. The administration promises to keep all other information as confidential as possible.

A school employee who has witnessed or has reliable information that a student or school employee has been subject to any act of bullying or harassing behavior shall immediately report the incident in writing to the Director for Student Affairs, Director for Academic Affairs, or [Executive Director/Superintendent]. Reports against the Director for Student Affairs or Director for Academic Affairs shall immediately be made in writing to the [Executive Director/Superintendent], and reports against the [Executive Director/Superintendent] shall immediately be made in writing to the Chief Academic Officer at the Mississippi Department of Education.

The school administration shall investigate reported incidents of bullying within five (5) [working] days of receiving the report.

The school administration shall speak to the alleged victim and alleged bully separately. Students may submit evidence for the school administration to review and a list of witnesses for the

school administration to speak with. Students should preserve evidence of bullying/cyberbullying and/or harassing behavior.